

Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — Course Syllabus

6 weeks · 2 sessions per week · 12 sessions · 2 hours per session · 24 instructional hours

Course	Microsoft Azure Fundamentals — Exam AZ-900 Preparation
Level	Beginner. No cloud experience required.
Format	Instructor-led, with hands-on activities every session
Certification target	Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals
Exam	AZ-900, scheduled within 10 days after the final session
Instructor	_____
Contact	_____
Office hours	_____
Session days and times	_____
Location or meeting link	_____

Course description

This course takes you from no cloud background to ready to sit Exam AZ-900, Microsoft Azure Fundamentals, in six weeks. You will learn what cloud computing is and how it changes who is responsible for what; how Azure is organized into regions, subscriptions, and resource groups; what Azure's core compute, networking, storage, and identity services do and when to choose each one; and how organizations control cost, enforce governance, deploy resources, and monitor what they have built.

Every topic in this course maps to an objective Microsoft publishes for the exam. The course covers all 57 of them, weighted to match the exam itself.

You do not need prior IT experience. Sessions 1 and 2 build the vocabulary that the rest of the course depends on.

What you will be able to do

By the final session you will be able to:

1. Explain cloud computing, the shared responsibility model, cloud deployment models, and cloud service types, and pick the right model for a described situation.
2. Describe how Azure is organized physically and administratively, and place any resource correctly in the management group, subscription, resource group, and resource hierarchy.
3. Compare Azure compute, networking, and storage options and select a reasonable service for a stated requirement.

4. Describe Azure identity, access, and security features including Microsoft Entra ID, multifactor and passwordless authentication, Conditional Access, role-based access control, Zero Trust, defense in depth, and Microsoft Defender for Cloud.
5. Describe how Azure costs arise, estimate them with the pricing calculator, and describe Azure's governance, deployment, and monitoring tools.
6. Answer AZ-900-style questions across all three exam domains at a level that supports passing the exam.

What the exam covers

The exam has three domains. Class time is allocated to match their weights.

Domain	Share of exam	Sessions
Describe cloud concepts	25–30%	1–2, revisited throughout
Describe Azure architecture and services	35–40%	3–7
Describe Azure management and governance	30–35%	8–11

Exam facts worth knowing on day one:

- **45 minutes** of exam time, within a **65-minute** appointment.
- A score of **700 or greater** passes. The score is not a simple percentage of questions.
- The exam is **proctored**, in a test center or online.
- You **cannot** look things up on Microsoft Learn during a Fundamentals exam. That feature exists only for the more advanced role-based exams, and learners are often surprised by this.
- If you do not pass, you may retake after **24 hours**. Later retakes have longer waits.
- This certification **does not expire**.

Course schedule

Sessions are numbered rather than dated, so the schedule works with any cadence. Your instructor will fill in actual meeting times above.

Week	Session	Topic	You will do
1	1	Cloud Computing Foundations	Sort responsibilities between provider and customer; match scenarios to cloud models; tour the Azure portal
1	2	Cloud Benefits, Pricing Models, and IaaS/PaaS/SaaS	Triage workloads into service types; match workloads to pricing models; see a serverless function created
2	3	Azure Architecture	Create a resource group, deploy a resource, tag it, and draw the Azure hierarchy
2	4	Azure Compute	Build a website endpoint with Azure Functions; compare virtual machine and App Service creation side by side

Week	Session	Topic	You will do
3	5	Azure Networking	Create a virtual network and subnets from the command line; sort public, private, and service endpoints
3	6	Azure Storage	Deploy a static website or a secure file share; price two storage designs and explain the difference
4	7	Azure Identity, Access, and Security	Set up new employee access with Microsoft Entra ID and role-based access control; tour Defender for Cloud
4	8	Azure Cost Management	Set up cost guardrails; build a pricing estimate and re-price it in a second region; apply a tag set
5	9	Governance and Compliance	Assign a policy and read its compliance results; apply a resource lock and try to delete through it
5	10	Managing and Deploying Azure Resources	Do the same task three ways — portal, CLI, PowerShell; export and redeploy a template
6	11	Monitoring and Cumulative Review	Create a Service Health alert; run a Log Analytics query; rate your confidence on every exam objective
6	12	Full Exam Readiness	Timed 45-minute practice under exam conditions, full debrief, and your personal 10-day plan

What a session looks like

Every session runs the same shape, so you always know what is coming:

Minutes	Block
10	Warm-up — quick recall questions on earlier sessions. Not graded.
50	Instruction — new material in two or three blocks, with worked examples
30	Practice — hands-on in Azure, or a structured sorting or estimating activity
15	Quiz — mostly today's material, plus a few questions from earlier sessions
15	Wrap-up — review the quiz, clear up confusion, get your assignment

Sessions 3 and 8 replace the warm-up with a checkpoint quiz covering a whole exam domain. Session 12 replaces most of the session with timed practice and a debrief.

How assessment works

Nothing in this course is designed to sort or rank you. Every quiz exists to show you and your instructor which exam objectives are solid and which need another pass, while there is still time to fix them.

What	When	Length	Graded?
Warm-up recall questions	Start of every session after the first	10 min, 6 questions	No

What	When	Length	Graded?
Session quiz	End of every session	10–15 min, 10–12 questions	Yes, for feedback
Domain 1 checkpoint	Start of Session 3	15 min, 12 questions	Yes, for feedback
Domain 2 checkpoint	Start of Session 8	15 min, 12 questions	Yes, for feedback
Domain 3 checkpoint	Inside the Session 11 quiz	15 min, 12 questions	Yes, for feedback
Final readiness practice	Session 12, timed	45 min, 45 questions	Yes, for feedback
Microsoft's official practice assessment	Session 11 homework, then during the 10-day window	45 min	Not collected

Question styles match the exam: single best answer, select-all-that-apply, matching, and yes/no statement sets. Every question is reviewed in class right after the quiz, and every one is tied to a published exam objective so you can look up exactly what to study.

How your quizzes are delivered

Your instructor will use one of these. They will tell you which in Session 1, and will fill in the details below.

- **Online quiz link** — you open a link at the end of each session, answer on your phone or laptop, and see your score immediately. Where to find the link:
- **Learning platform** — the quizzes are posted in the course platform (for example Canvas, Moodle, or Teams) and you take them there. Platform and login:
- **On paper** — you are handed the questions and an answer sheet in class, and hand it back at the end.

Whichever method is used, you also get the questions with the correct answers, the reasoning, and a Microsoft Learn link for each one after the review. Keep those; they are your revision material.

Readiness bar before you book the exam

You are ready when **all three** of these are true:

1. 85% or better on the Session 12 final readiness practice, with no single domain below 75%.
2. 85% or better on a separate attempt at Microsoft's official practice assessment, again with no domain below 75%.
3. No objective left marked "blank" on your objective checklist.

The bar sits above the actual passing score on purpose. Practice scores and exam scores are not the same measure, and Microsoft does not publish a relationship between them.

What you need to do

Before Session 1

1. **Create a free Microsoft Learn account** at learn.microsoft.com. Use a personal Microsoft account rather than a work or school account. This matters later: if you register for the exam with a work account and then leave that organization, your certification records can be lost and cannot be recovered. - This account is free, gives you every training module used in this course, and gives you the official practice assessment.
2. **Decide how you will do hands-on work.** Any one of these is fine: - Create your own [Azure free account](#). Check the current offer terms on that page — what is included changes from time to time. A credit card is used for identity verification; you are not charged unless you choose to upgrade. Students should check whether the **Azure free student account** applies to them, which needs no credit card. - Use a subscription your organization or instructor provides. - Use the no-cost path. Every session has an alternative activity that needs no Azure subscription, using Microsoft Learn's guided projects, the pricing calculator, and instructor demonstrations. **You can complete and pass this course without ever creating an Azure account.**
3. **Bring a device** that can open a browser: laptop preferred, tablet or phone workable.

Every week

- **Attend both sessions.** The warm-up at the start and the quiz review at the end are where most of the learning happens, and neither can be caught up by reading slides.
- **Complete the assigned Microsoft Learn module** before the next session — roughly 45–60 minutes. Each module ends with a short knowledge check; do it.
- **Delete any Azure resources you created in class** at the end of each session if you are using your own subscription. You will learn how in Session 3. This is a real cloud skill, not just housekeeping.
- **Keep your objective checklist current.** You will get a list of all 57 exam objectives. After each quiz review, mark each one you touched: confident, shaky, or blank. Bring it to every session; Sessions 11 and 12 are built around it.

After the final session — your 10-day plan

You will get this as a handout in Session 12. The short version:

Day	Focus
1	Review your Session 12 debrief and book your exam for day 8, 9, or 10
2	Cloud concepts
3	Azure architecture and compute
4	Networking and storage
5	Identity and security
6	Cost, governance, management, and monitoring
7	Full official practice assessment, timed; review every miss

Day	Focus
8	Repair only the objectives you missed on day 7
9	Second full practice assessment; confirm the readiness bar; walk the exam sandbox again
10	Sit the exam. Light review only — no new material

Booking the exam on day 1 is the single most important step. Learners who leave the booking until they "feel ready" tend never to book at all.

Materials

Everything required for this course is free.

Item	Where	Cost
Official training modules	Introduction to Cloud Infrastructure learning paths on Microsoft Learn	Free
Official exam study guide	AZ-900 study guide	Free
Official practice assessment	AZ-900 practice assessment	Free
Exam interface demo	Exam sandbox	Free
Hands-on environment	Azure free account, a provided subscription, or the no-cost path	Free or provided
Class quizzes, handouts, and objective checklist	Provided by your instructor	Free
The exam itself	Scheduled through Pearson VUE, or Certiport for students and educators	Paid — price varies by country or region

The exam fee is the only cost in this course, and it is paid to Microsoft's testing partner, not to the course.

A note on study materials you find online

You will find many free AZ-900 guides, videos, and question sets. Two things to know:

- **Microsoft's own documentation is the authority.** Where any other source disagrees with Microsoft Learn, Microsoft Learn is right. Third-party material also goes stale — the exam was last updated in July 2026, and much of what is online predates that. Expect to see retired product names such as "Azure Active Directory" (now Microsoft Entra ID) and tools that no longer exist, such as the Total Cost of Ownership calculator.
- **Do not use exam dumps.** Sites offering "real exam questions" violate the agreement you accept when you register for the exam, and can cost you your certification. They also do not work: the exam tests whether you can pick the right service for a situation, which memorized answers do not teach you. Everything you need is free and legitimate, and this course points you at all of it.

Policies

Attendance. Attend all 12 sessions. If you miss one, get the session's objective list and the quiz with its answer key from your instructor, complete the Microsoft Learn module for that session, and take the quiz on your own before the next session. Tell your instructor which objectives felt shaky so they can fold them into a warm-up.

Participation. The sorting, matching, and estimating activities work only if you commit to an answer and defend it. Being wrong out loud in Session 2 is much cheaper than being wrong on the exam in Week 7.

Quizzes. Open-book is fine for warm-ups and session quizzes if your instructor allows it, but it defeats the purpose — the point is to find out what you can recall unaided. The Session 12 final practice is closed-book and timed, because the exam is.

Late work. The Microsoft Learn modules are not graded, but skipping them compounds quickly. Each session assumes the previous module is done.

Academic honesty. Do your own quizzes. Do not share questions or answers outside the class, and do not bring exam dump material into the course.

Accessibility and accommodations. Tell your instructor what you need and it will be arranged — every activity in this course has a keyboard-only path, and diagrams have text equivalents. For the exam itself, Microsoft offers accommodations including extra time and assistive technology support, but **you must request them before you register**. Start at [Request accommodations](#), and ask your instructor in Session 1 if you plan to request anything, so there is time.

Cost safety. If you use your own Azure subscription, you are responsible for what you create. Delete class resources at the end of each session, and set a budget alert once Session 8 teaches you how. Use the no-cost path if you would rather not manage this.

Frequently asked questions

Do I need IT experience? No. Microsoft's own audience description assumes some, but this course does not. Sessions 1 and 2 build the vocabulary from scratch.

Do I need to know how to code? No. Nothing in this course or the exam requires coding. You will see a few command-line commands and a template file, and both are explained.

Do I have to create an Azure account? No. Hands-on work is strongly encouraged because it makes the concepts stick, but every session has a no-cost alternative.

Will this course make me an Azure administrator? No, and that is by design. AZ-900 is a foundational certification that proves you can describe Azure's services and features. It is the normal first step toward role-based certifications such as Azure Administrator.

Is AZ-900 required before other Azure certifications? No. It is not a prerequisite for anything. It is a common starting point because it makes the later material much easier.

What if I fail the exam? You can retake it 24 hours later, with longer waits for subsequent attempts. Your score report shows performance by domain, which tells you exactly where to study. Bring it to your instructor.

How much study time outside class should I plan? Roughly 1–2 hours per week during the course for the assigned module and review, then 1–2 hours a day during the 10-day window after it.

This course is built entirely against Microsoft's current published AZ-900 objectives (skills measured as of July 20, 2026) and the official Microsoft Learn training content. No exam dump material is used anywhere in it.